

A fateful day

In 1973, a people’s movement against the destruction of the forests began in the region. A fateful day brought Devi into the thick of it, when she led the women and girls of Reni into the forest to protect it from being cut down by loggers. Devi’s courage in standing up to abuse and threats that day brought the ‘chipko’ movement into the limelight and encouraged women to join it in large numbers. The Chipko Movement has remained a landmark environmentalist movement for its adoption of non-violent methods and for its involvement of the rural poor, who are often the worst affected by environmental disasters.